

MRD-HR-001 Leave & Time-Off Policy v3.1

Effective 1 January 2026 · Owner: People Ops

1 Purpose

This policy sets out paid and unpaid leave entitlements for all Meridian Labs employees in the United Kingdom and Ireland.

2 Annual Leave

2.1 Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays.

2.2 Leave accrues at 2.08 days per completed calendar month.

2.3 Employees joining mid-year receive a pro-rated entitlement, rounded up to the nearest half day.

2.4 A maximum of 5 unused days may be carried into the following year. Carried days expire on 31 March and are not paid out.

3 Sick Leave

3.1 Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year.

3.2 A medical certificate is required only for absences of 3 or more consecutive working days.

3.3 Sick leave does not accrue and does not carry over.

4 Parental Leave

4.1 Primary caregivers receive 26 weeks at full pay after 12 months of continuous service.

4.2 Secondary caregivers receive 8 weeks at full pay.

4.3 Parental leave must begin within 12 months of the birth or placement.

5 Unpaid Leave

5.1 Requests for unpaid leave beyond 10 working days require Director approval.

5.2 Unpaid leave does not interrupt continuous service.

6 Requesting Leave

6.1 All leave is requested in Workday at least 10 working days in advance, except sick leave.

6.2 Requests are approved by the employee's direct manager.